

CZ Email Frequency Holdout Test — April 2026

Test Period: April 1 — April 30, 2026 **Brand:** The Citizenry (CZ) **Data Sources:** Braze Raw Events Datashare (Snowflake) · GA4 (Snowflake)

1. Test Design

The holdout group was defined using Braze random bucket numbers, ensuring random assignment with no selection bias. The holdout segment ("Full File List - Holdout") was excluded from certain sends each week via Braze's Additional Filters. Major sale and product launch emails were intentionally sent to the full list — the holdout only reduced exposure to editorial, back-in-stock, and lighter cadence emails.

Group sizes:

Group	Users	Share of list
Control (full frequency)	~79,000	~81%
Holdout (reduced frequency)	~21,000	~19%

Frequency result:

Segment	Control emails/month	Holdout emails/month	Reduction
Full File	15	12	–20%
Engaged	23	17	–26%

2. What the Holdout Group Missed

The following 6 campaigns (intentionally) had the holdout exclusion applied. All Sleep Well Sale sends — the month's major event — went to the full list.

Date	Campaign	Type
Apr 1	April Edit	Editorial
Apr 10	Pillow Pairings	Editorial
Apr 13	Back in Stock	Product
Apr 17	Earth Day Sleep Well Sale	Sale (engaged list)
Apr 24	Spa Towel Guide	Editorial

Date	Campaign	Type
Apr 29	Archive Sale	Sale

Sleep Well Sale (sent to everyone, holdout included): 7 campaigns Apr 15–27.

One execution note: The Apr 28 Spring Collection Launch was accidentally sent with the holdout filter applied. This was a mistake — it was not marked for holdout exclusion in the Asana task.

3. Engagement Results

Each group is broken into two sub-segments based on list membership. The sub-segment totals add up to the Section 1 group sizes: holdout 12,469 + 8,463 = **20,932** (~21K); control 48,290 + 31,020 = **79,310** (~79K).

Full File sub-segment

(users on the full file list only — lower baseline engagement)

Metric	Holdout (12 emails)	Control (15 emails)	Δ
Users	12,469	48,290	—
% Opened any email	2.4%	1.5%	+0.9pp
% Clicked any email	1.8%	1.0%	+0.8pp
Unsubscribe rate	0.88%	0.17%	+5.1× higher for holdout

Engaged sub-segment

(users on both the full file and engaged lists — higher baseline engagement)

Metric	Holdout (17 emails)	Control (23 emails)	Δ
Users	8,463	31,020	—
% Opened any email	40.0%	41.2%	−1.2pp
% Clicked any email	14.7%	15.6%	−0.9pp
Unsubscribe rate	0.67%	0.10%	+6.7× higher for holdout

Key finding: For the engaged sub-segment, open and click rates were essentially identical between groups — reducing frequency by 26% had no measurable impact on per-email engagement quality. However, the holdout group unsubscribed at nearly 7× the rate of the control across both sub-segments.

A note on unsubscribe attribution

After team review, a per-campaign breakdown of unsubscribes was investigated. A subset of holdout group unsubs (~30–40 out of 167 total) appeared attributed to campaigns from as far back as November 2025 (BFCM) and February 2026 (Presidents Day). These are almost certainly a **Braze attribution artifact**: when a campaign is created by copying an older one, the unsubscribe link can retain the original campaign's tracking ID. When a user unsubscribes from an April 2026 send, the event is occasionally logged against the source campaign rather than the current one. The control group shows almost none of this pattern, likely because their unsubs came from the renamed/current campaign versions.

These ~30–40 misattributed events represent a minority of the total unsub difference and do not change the conclusion. The remaining unsubs — from confirmed April 2026 campaigns that both groups received — still show the holdout group unsubscribing at significantly higher rates.

4. Statistical Significance

Z-test for two proportions (two-tailed, $\alpha = 0.05$).

Segment	Metric	z-score	p-value	Significant?
Engaged	Open rate (40.0% vs 41.2%)	−1.99	0.047	Marginal — small practical difference
Engaged	Click rate (14.7% vs 15.6%)	−2.03	0.042	Marginal — small practical difference
Engaged	Unsub rate (0.67% vs 0.10%)	9.92	<0.001	Highly significant
Full File	Unsub rate (0.88% vs 0.17%)	12.49	<0.001	Highly significant

The unsubscribe rate difference is statistically certain. The open/click rate differences are borderline and small in practical terms.

5. Revenue & Sessions (GA4)

Total email channel — April 2026

Metric	Value
Total sessions	22,040
Total purchases	223
Total revenue	\$73,129
Average order value	\$328

Top revenue-driving campaigns

Campaign	Sessions	Revenue	Rev/Session	Holdout received?
Back in Stock (Apr 26)	1,599	\$5,643	\$3.53	✓ Yes
Sleep Well Sale Last Chance (Apr 27)	598	\$4,435	\$7.42	✓ Yes
PT Spring Sale Reminder (Apr 25)	919	\$4,320	\$4.70	✓ Yes
Archive Sale (Apr 15)	1,442	\$4,064	\$2.82	✓ Yes
Sleep Well Sale Reminder (Apr 19)	572	\$3,851	\$6.73	✓ Yes
Sleep Well Sale Launch (Apr 16)	792	\$2,410	\$3.04	✓ Yes
Back in Stock (Apr 13)	1,033	\$1,560	\$1.51	✗ No (holdout excluded)
Archive Sale (Apr 29)	1,118	\$1,763	\$1.58	✗ No (holdout excluded)

The Sleep Well Sale drove **\$23,548 (32% of April email revenue)** — and the holdout group received every email in that series.

Estimated revenue impact on holdout group

The 6 intentionally withheld campaigns generated a combined **\$7,922 in revenue** across **5,172 sessions**. Based on the holdout group's share of each campaign's audience, the estimated direct revenue missed by the holdout group is approximately **~\$1,800–\$2,000** (~2.5% of total April email revenue).

6. Does the Test Support the Hypothesis?

Hypothesis: Reducing email frequency will increase clicks, sessions, and revenue, and decrease unsubscribes.

Goal	Result	Verdict
↑ Clicks	Full file holdout clicked slightly more (1.8% vs 1.0%); engaged group nearly identical (14.7% vs 15.6%)	Weak / neutral
↑ Sessions & Revenue	Holdout missed ~\$2K in direct revenue and ~1,300 sessions from withheld campaigns	Did not improve
↓ Unsubscribes	Holdout unsubscribed at 5–7× the rate of control — highly statistically significant	Contradicted

7. Conclusion

The test does not support reducing email frequency for CZ.

The most important finding is the unsubscribe rate. Even though the holdout group received all major sale emails, they left the list at 5–7× the rate of the control group. Since the holdout was randomly assigned, this is a real causal effect of the frequency reduction — not a list quality difference.

For the engaged segment specifically: open and click rates were nearly identical (40% vs 41%), confirming that these subscribers handle the current cadence without fatigue. But they churn at a dramatically higher rate when frequency is reduced, suggesting that consistent contact is what retains them.

The direct revenue impact of the withheld campaigns (~\$2K) is small. The larger risk is long-term list decay: losing engaged subscribers at 6.7× the normal rate compounds over time and erodes the sendable audience.

Recommendation: Maintain current send frequency for CZ. Do not expand the holdout or reduce cadence for this brand based on this test.

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